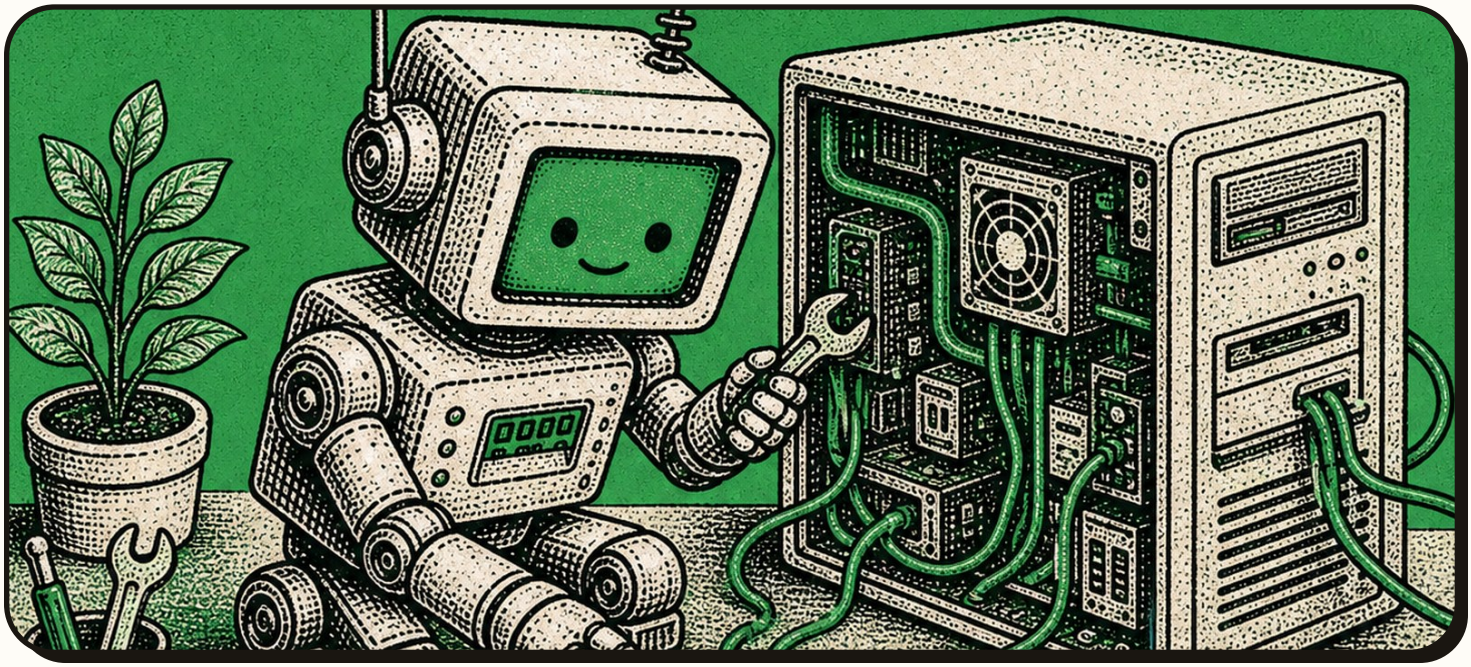
Good Websites

AUTHORITY CHECKLIST JULY 2026 / 10-POINT SELF-AUDIT

THE TECHNICAL SEO + INDEXABILITY CHECKLIST

A crawl, rendering, and validation audit for clinics



BUILD AUTHORITY ON PURPOSE.

Remove the technical barriers that prevent useful pages from being discovered, crawled, indexed, understood, and measured.

10 CHECKS	5 FOCUS AREAS	1 ACTION PLAN

Make every intended page reachable.

Search eligibility starts with public access, successful responses, and indexable content.

1 Serve public indexable pages with a 200 status

WHY IT MATTERS

Every page intended for search should be publicly accessible, return a successful HTTP response, and contain meaningful indexable content rather than an error, login, or empty shell.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Preferred URLs return HTTP 200
- [ ] No login or consent wall blocks content
- [ ] Soft 404 and empty pages are identified
- [ ] Main text is present in the rendered page

QUICK TEST Does URL Inspection see the same useful page a visitor sees?

2 Allow the required crawlers through every layer

WHY IT MATTERS

Check robots.txt, CDN settings, firewalls, bot protection, hosting rules, and staging controls. A page cannot be evaluated if the crawler cannot reliably reach it.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Robots.txt allows intended content
- [ ] CDN and firewall do not block Googlebot
- [ ] Staging restrictions are absent in production
- [ ] Critical CSS, scripts, and images are crawlable

QUICK TEST Could infrastructure block a crawler even when robots.txt looks correct?

Tell search engines which URLs belong.

Indexing directives, canonicals, and redirects should express one coherent URL strategy.

3 Audit robots meta and snippet controls

WHY IT MATTERS

Use index, noindex, nosnippet, and related controls intentionally. Remember that crawlers must access a page before they can read its page-level directives.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Indexable pages have no accidental noindex
- [ ] Noindex pages remain crawlable when needed
- [ ] Snippet limits are intentional
- [ ] HTTP and HTML directives do not conflict

QUICK TEST Can you explain why every excluded page is excluded?

4 Use canonicals and redirects consistently

WHY IT MATTERS

Choose one preferred URL for duplicate or near-duplicate content. Align canonical tags, redirects, internal links, sitemaps, protocol, hostname, and trailing-slash behaviour.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Each indexable page has a sensible canonical
- [ ] Redirect chains and loops are removed
- [ ] Internal links point to preferred URLs
- [ ] Canonical and sitemap signals agree

QUICK TEST Do all technical signals nominate the same preferred URL?

Build discoverable paths through the site.

Sitemaps help discovery, but crawlable internal links explain hierarchy and importance.

5 Maintain a clean XML sitemap

WHY IT MATTERS

Include only canonical, indexable, successful URLs that matter. Keep last-modified data honest, submit the sitemap in Search Console, and monitor processing errors.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Only preferred indexable URLs are included
- [ ] All sitemap URLs return HTTP 200
- [ ] Last-modified values reflect real changes
- [ ] Sitemap status is monitored in Search Console

QUICK TEST Would every URL in the sitemap deserve to appear in search?

6 Use crawlable and descriptive internal links

WHY IT MATTERS

Link important pages using standard anchor elements and useful anchor text. Eliminate orphan pages and create logical routes between services, practitioners, locations, and articles.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Important pages receive crawlable links
- [ ] Anchor text describes the destination
- [ ] Orphan pages are found and resolved
- [ ] Site hierarchy is understandable from links

QUICK TEST Can a crawler reach every priority page without using the sitemap?

Deliver the important content reliably.

Rendering, mobile experience, and accessible structure determine whether pages work in practice.

7 Keep essential content in the rendered HTML

WHY IT MATTERS

Make sure headings, body copy, links, practitioner details, and calls to action appear in the rendered DOM. Do not rely on images or fragile scripts for critical information.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Main text appears in the rendered DOM
- [ ] Navigation links render as real links
- [ ] Lazy loading does not hide critical content
- [ ] Important information is not image-only

QUICK TEST Does the rendered page preserve every fact needed for search and booking?

8 Validate mobile performance and page stability

WHY IT MATTERS

Test real mobile loading, responsiveness, visual stability, HTTPS, forms, keyboard access, and readable layouts. Fix failures that prevent patients from using the page.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Core content loads promptly on mobile
- [ ] Layout does not jump during loading
- [ ] HTTPS and forms work without errors
- [ ] Keyboard and readable layout checks pass

QUICK TEST Can a patient complete the key task on a slow mobile connection?

Test what search engines actually receive.

Search Console and validation tools turn technical assumptions into observable evidence.

9 Validate structured data against visible content

WHY IT MATTERS

Use supported, relevant types and complete properties. Ensure markup describes what users can actually see, then test it before and after deployment.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Markup uses applicable supported types
- [ ] Structured data matches visible content
- [ ] Rich Results Test has no critical errors
- [ ] Deployed pages are monitored for breakage

QUICK TEST Could any markup be interpreted as incomplete, hidden, or misleading?

10 Monitor indexing, crawling, and changes

WHY IT MATTERS

Use Page Indexing, Crawl Stats, URL Inspection, sitemap reports, performance data, and release notes to catch regressions. Assign owners and document the fix history.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Page Indexing issues are reviewed
- [ ] Crawl Stats anomalies are investigated
- [ ] Priority URLs are tested after releases
- [ ] Technical fixes have owners and dates

QUICK TEST How quickly would the team notice an accidental site-wide noindex?

ADD UP YOUR SCORE.

Count the large checkbox on each item you can confidently tick today.

MY AUTHORITY SCORE

____ / 10

Fix one high-impact gap first.

0-3

Foundation missing

Resolve identity, access, accuracy, and essential trust gaps first.

4-6

Credible start

Choose the gaps with the greatest effect on patients and discovery.

7-9

Strong authority

Close the remaining gaps and make review part of normal operations.

10

Ready to compound

Maintain the standard, measure outcomes, and keep improving.

Your first improvement sprint

1. Highest-impact gap: _____

2. Owner + target date: _____

3. How success will be measured: _____

Want a second set of eyes?

Book a free 20-minute website review and walk through the checklist together.

BOOK A FREE CALL ->

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MEMBER NOTE: Educational only - not CONO approval or legal advice; registrants remain responsible for current standards, scope, and advertising.

GUIDANCE USED Google: Technical requirements | Google: Sitemaps overview | Google: Robots meta specifications